

AJAY DHAGE

Bengaluru, Karnataka, India | +91-7847019704 | dhageajay012@gmail.com
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/ajay-dhage-88aab9164 | GitHub: github.com/githubajaydhage
Technical Lead | Senior DevOps Engineer | SRE | Kubernetes | AWS | Terraform | Platform Engineering

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven **Senior DevOps / Site Reliability Engineer (SRE)** with **5+ years of experience** designing, automating, and operating **cloud-native microservices architecture** on **AWS, Azure, and GCP**. Expert in **Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE)**, CI/CD (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, ArgoCD, FluxCD), **Infrastructure as Code & Infrastructure Automation** (Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation), and **DevSecOps** (Trivy, Falco, OPA Gatekeeper, Snyk, Vault). Manages production EKS clusters delivering **99.95% uptime** and **high availability** at ~5,000 TPS across distributed systems. Reduced **MTTR by 35%**, release cycles by **60%**, and infrastructure costs by **25%**. Proficient with enterprise tooling: **Datadog, PagerDuty, Jira, ServiceNow, and Confluence**. Strong track record in **disaster recovery**, vulnerability management, scalability, compliance & policy enforcement, stakeholder management, and root cause analysis.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms:	AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, RDS, ALB/NLB, Route 53, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Lambda, ECS/Fargate, SNS, SQS), Azure (AKS, Azure DevOps, Azure Monitor), GCP (GKE, Cloud Build, Stackdriver)
Containers & Orchestration:	Kubernetes (EKS, AKS, GKE), Docker, Helm, Kustomize, OpenShift, HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Cluster Autoscaler, Pod Disruption Budgets, Topology Spread Constraints
CI/CD & GitOps:	Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, Azure Pipelines, ArgoCD, ArgoCD Rollouts, FluxCD, Flagger, Bamboo, TeamCity, JFrog Artifactory, Trunk-Based Development
Infrastructure as Code:	Terraform (modules, workspaces, remote state, Sentinel), Ansible, CloudFormation, Packer, Crossplane, Pulumi
Service Mesh & Networking:	Istio, Linkerd, Envoy, Nginx Ingress, HAProxy, AWS ALB/NLB, Route 53, mTLS, SSL/TLS, Zero-Trust Networking, eBPF, TCP/IP, HTTP/HTTPS
Security & DevSecOps:	IAM/RBAC, OPA Gatekeeper, Falco, Trivy, Snyk, SonarQube, Veracode, Clair, HashiCorp Vault, AWS Secrets Manager, SAST/DAST, CIS Benchmarks, Pod Security Standards, Cosign (image signing)
Observability & Monitoring:	Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), Datadog, Splunk, Dynatrace, New Relic, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry, Distributed Tracing, SLI/SLO/Error Budgets
Incident & ITSM:	PagerDuty, ServiceNow, Jira, Confluence, Opsgenie, P0/P1 Incident Management, On-Call Rotation, RCA / Postmortems, ITIL, Blameless Culture
Databases & Messaging:	MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ
Scripting & Programming:	Bash / Shell Scripting, Python, YAML, JSON, Groovy (Jenkinsfile), Go (basic)
Reliability Engineering:	SLA/SLO/SLI, Error Budgets, Capacity Planning, Chaos Engineering, Disaster Recovery (DR), High Availability (HA/DR), Blue/Green, Canary, Rolling Deployments, Autoscaling, Scalability, Distributed Systems, Cost Optimization, high availability
Methodologies:	Agile / Scrum, SAFe, DevOps, DevSecOps, GitOps, SRE Principles, ITIL Incident Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead - Platform Engineering & Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Oct 2024 - Present

- Lead and mentor a team of 3 DevOps/SRE engineers; drive cross-functional collaboration with Product, QA, and Operations for zero-downtime platform delivery.
- Own Kubernetes production clusters (10-20 EKS worker nodes, 45+ microservices, 200+ pods) processing ~5,000 TPS across dev/staging/prod with 99.95% SLA.
- Defined SLA/SLO/SLI metrics, error budgets, and Prometheus-based alerting rules; reduced MTTR by 35% and eliminated 40% of alert noise through runbook automation.
- Led P0/P1 incident response war-room calls and root cause analysis (RCA); coordinated multi-team rollback for UPS production deployment and delivered structured postmortems with stakeholder-facing corrective action plans in Jira and Confluence.

- Implemented Blue/Green and Canary deployment strategies using ArgoCD Rollouts and Flagger with automated rollback on SLO breach - zero failed production releases in 6 months.
- Designed multi-region HA/DR architecture (us-east-1 + ap-south-1) with cross-region RDS replication, S3 versioning, and automated failover; achieved RPO < 1 hr, RTO < 30 min.
- Automated end-to-end infrastructure provisioning and infrastructure automation via Terraform modules and GitOps (ArgoCD); eliminated configuration drift, improved scalability, and reduced provisioning time by 70%.
- Implemented DevSecOps pipeline for vulnerability management: Trivy (container scanning), Falco (runtime threat detection), OPA Gatekeeper (policy enforcement & compliance), Snyk (dependency CVEs) - 100% policy-compliant deployments.
- Optimised HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, and Cluster Autoscaler; right-sized 45 workloads and reduced monthly AWS spend by 25% (\$18K/month savings).
- Integrated Datadog APM and PagerDuty for real-time alerting and on-call scheduling; reduced mean time to acknowledge (MTTA) by 50%.
- Managed Helm chart versioning, Kustomize overlays, and Istio service mesh (mTLS, circuit breaking, traffic shifting) across all cluster environments.

Senior Engineer - DevOps / Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Feb 2023 - Sept 2024

- Architected a Kubernetes-based messaging platform processing 50M+ API transactions/day with auto-scaling and multi-AZ high availability.
- Built CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI) with parallel test execution, JFrog Artifactory, Trivy/Snyk scanning, and zero-downtime deployments; cut release cycle by 60%.
- Configured Nginx Ingress, AWS ALB/NLB, Route 53 DNS routing, SSL/TLS termination, and WAF rules; enforced least-privilege IAM/RBAC policies across all environments.
- Deployed centralised observability stack (Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Alertmanager, Jaeger, OpenTelemetry) enabling full-stack metrics, log aggregation, and distributed tracing.
- Evaluated and implemented Istio and Linkerd service mesh for east-west traffic management, service-to-service mTLS, and advanced load balancing; reduced inter-service latency by 15%.
- Integrated HashiCorp Vault and AWS Secrets Manager for dynamic secrets injection - eliminated hardcoded credentials from all 45+ services.
- Implemented multi-AZ deployment patterns, PodDisruptionBudgets, and topology spread constraints to achieve zero-downtime maintenance windows.
- Authored 20+ reusable Terraform modules for VPC, EKS, RDS, and IAM across 3 AWS accounts; enforced Sentinel governance policies.
- Managed PagerDuty on-call schedules and ServiceNow incident tickets; reduced MTTR from 45 min to 29 min over 18 months.

Engineer - Software Development & DevOps

Comviva Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Sept 2021 - Jan 2023

- Developed containerised microservices (Java, Spring Boot, REST APIs) on Kubernetes; authored Dockerfiles, Helm charts, and GitHub Actions pipelines for automated builds and deployments.
- Built automated testing frameworks (unit, integration, regression) in CI pipelines with SonarQube quality gates; reduced production defects by 40%.
- Assisted AWS cloud migration from monolithic architecture to microservices on EKS; improved independent deployability and reduced release coupling.
- Managed AWS resources (EC2, S3, RDS, VPC, IAM) and contributed Terraform changes in Agile/Scrum sprints tracked via Jira and Confluence.
- Configured Prometheus alerting rules and Grafana dashboards for latency, error rate, and resource utilisation monitoring.

CMS Web Developer

Simplotel Technologies | Bengaluru, India | Nov 2020 - July 2021

- Built and optimised CMS-based web solutions for 15+ hospitality clients; improved page load speed by 30% through caching and frontend tuning.
- Integrated REST APIs, implemented SEO improvements, and delivered UI/UX enhancements in Agile/Scrum sprints; managed deployments via Git version control.

KEY PLATFORM ENGINEERING PROJECTS

Multi-Region EKS HA/DR Platform | AWS, EKS, Route 53, RDS, Terraform

- Active-passive multi-region (us-east-1 / ap-south-1) EKS platform with Route 53 health-check failover, cross-region RDS read replicas, and S3 cross-region replication.
- Automated failover runbook achieved RPO < 1 hr and RTO < 30 min; validated quarterly via chaos engineering drills (AWS Fault Injection Simulator).

GitOps Migration & Canary Deployments | ArgoCD, ArgoCD Rollouts, Flagger, Helm, Kustomize

- Migrated 45+ microservices from imperative kubectl to full GitOps using ArgoCD with Helm chart versioning and Kustomize overlays.
- Implemented Canary deployments via Flagger with Prometheus-based SLO gates and automated rollback on error-rate breach; 0 failed prod releases post-migration.

DevSecOps Pipeline Implementation | Trivy, Falco, OPA Gatekeeper, Snyk, Vault, Cosign

- Embedded shift-left security: Trivy image scans in CI, Snyk dependency checks, OPA Gatekeeper admission policies, Falco runtime alerts, and Cosign image signing.
- Achieved 100% policy-compliant deployments; reduced critical CVE exposure by 65% within 3 months.

Kubernetes Autoscaling & Cost Optimisation | HPA, VPA, KEDA, Karpenter, Spot Instances

- Deployed KEDA for event-driven autoscaling on Kafka consumers; Karpenter for intelligent node provisioning; VPA for resource right-sizing across 45 workloads.
- Reduced monthly AWS compute spend by 25% (~\$18K/month) while maintaining SLO adherence at peak load (5,000 TPS).

Centralised Observability Platform | Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, Datadog, Jaeger, PagerDuty

- Built unified observability: metrics (Prometheus + Grafana), logs (ELK Stack), traces (Jaeger + OpenTelemetry), and APM (Datadog) with PagerDuty on-call alerting.
- Reduced alert noise by 40%, MTTA by 50%, and enabled SLO dashboards for all production services.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)	Linux Foundation	In Progress - Target Q3 2026
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C03)	Amazon Web Services	In Progress - Target Q3 2026
HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate	HashiCorp	In Progress - Target Q4 2026
Docker Certified Associate (DCA)	Docker Inc.	In Progress - Target Q4 2026
Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA)	Linux Foundation	In Progress - Target Q4 2026

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS & METRICS

- **99.95% SLA** maintained for a ~5,000 TPS, 45-microservice Kubernetes production platform across multi-region AWS infrastructure.
- **35% MTTR reduction** (45 min to 29 min) via SLO-based alerting, automated runbooks, Datadog APM, and PagerDuty on-call integration.
- **60% faster release cycles** through fully automated CI/CD (Jenkins + GitHub Actions + ArgoCD) with parallel testing and zero-downtime Canary/Blue-Green deployments.
- **25% cloud cost savings** (~\$18K/month) via HPA/VPA/KEDA/Karpenter right-sizing, Spot Instance strategy, and Reserved Instance planning.
- **65% CVE reduction** in 3 months post DevSecOps pipeline implementation (Trivy + Snyk + OPA Gatekeeper + Cosign).
- **70% faster infrastructure provisioning** through Terraform module automation and GitOps-driven drift elimination.
- **40% reduction in production defects** via automated test frameworks and SonarQube quality gates in CI pipelines.
- **50% reduction in MTTA** after integrating Datadog APM with PagerDuty escalation policies and runbook-linked alerts.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering - Electronics and Communications Engineering

Guru Nanak Dev Engineering College, Bidar, Karnataka, India | 2016 - 2020